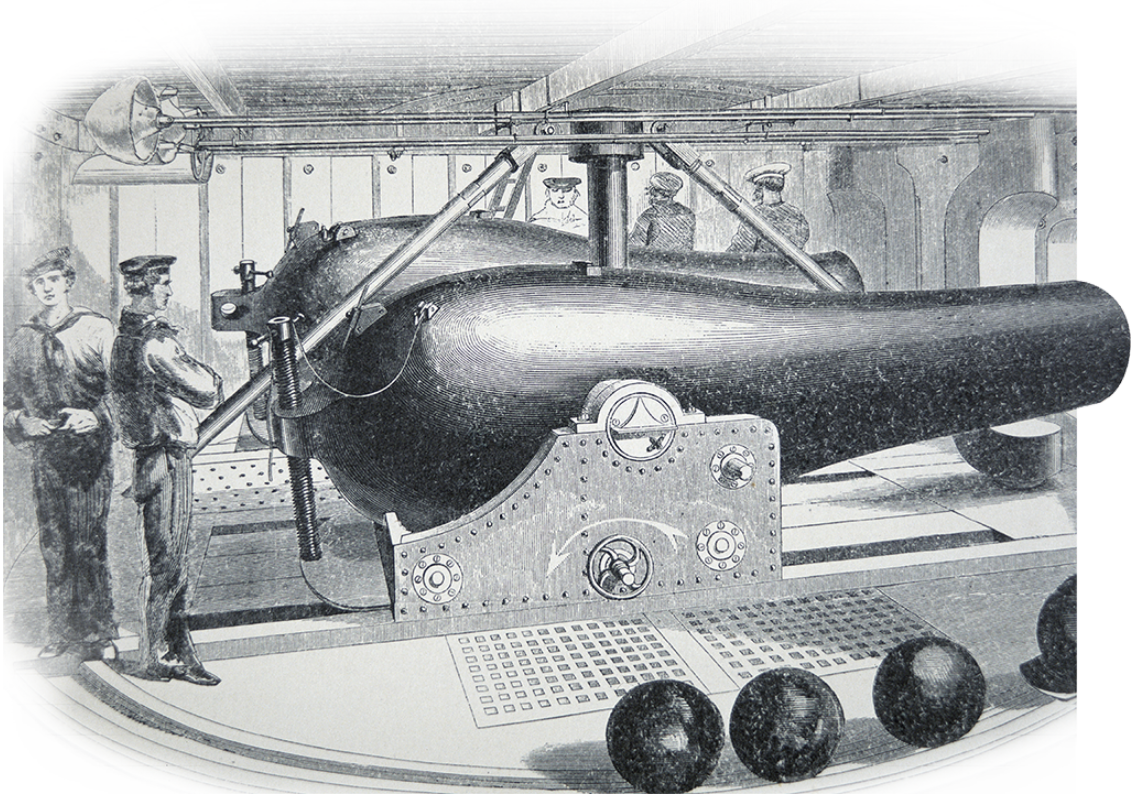


USS MONITOR



The design for USS *Monitor* was submitted to the U.S. Navy's Ironclad Board by Swedish-born engineer John Ericsson. This semi-submerged metal raft had an armored deck that supported a rotating gun turret and a small pilothouse. It was armed with two 11-in (280-mm) smoothbore Dahlgren guns (below). Their swollen shape allowed the use of larger amounts of explosive propellant without the risk of the gun bursting. The steam engine drove an innovative marine screw, also designed by Ericsson. The *Monitor's* low profile in the water made it a tough target but rendered it barely seaworthy. Built in sections at different foundries, the vessel was launched on January 30, 1862.

Final clashes

The *Virginia* tried to crush the *Monitor* by ramming, but the *Monitor* moved into shallow water to escape. No resolution seemed in view when by chance a Confederate shell exploded in the eyeslit of the *Monitor's* pilothouse. Worden suffered a facial wound that blinded him. There was some confusion before command passed to his first